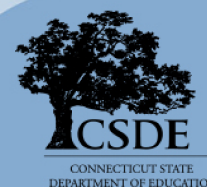


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



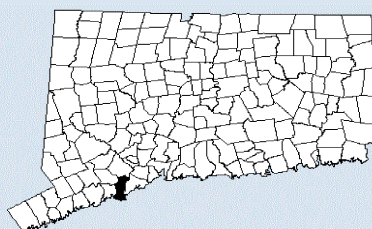
Stratford School District

Dr. Janet Robinson, Superintendent • 203-385-4210 • <https://www.stratfordk12.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	24
Enrollment	6,699
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,970
Total Expenditures ¹	\$122,895,225

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	3,257	48.6	48.4
Male	3,442	51.4	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	180	2.7	5.2
Black or African American	1,607	24.0	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2,446	36.5	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	281	4.2	4.0
White	2,176	32.5	49.9
English Learners	438	6.5	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	3,095	46.2	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	1,062	15.9	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed () when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.*

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	12	0.4
Male	927	27.2	69	1.9
Black or African American	498	30.5	27	1.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	706	28.9	30	1.1
White	357	17.0	18	0.8
English Learners	143	31.5	7	1.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,061	34.0	51	1.4
Students with Disabilities	386	36.1	29	2.3
District	1,659	25.0	81	1.1
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 46

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stratford School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	431.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	87.6
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	70.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	123.7
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	16.0
School Level	38.2
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	10.0
Support Staff	3.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	33.6
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	44.8
School Nurses	14.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	250.2

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	7	1.1	1.3
Black or African American	30	4.6	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	26	4.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	589	90.3	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	7.5	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	81	65.3	121	83.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	119	69.6	159	90.9
White	161	84.3	223	94.5
English Learners	8	*	20	80.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	148	66.1	197	87.2
Students with Disabilities	46	51.7	68	74.7
District	384	74.3	532	90.3
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	63	41.2
Emotional Disturbance	35	39.8
Intellectual Disability	15	32.6
Learning Disability	356	87.5
Other Health Impairment	158	76.3
Other Disabilities	21	32.8
Speech/Language Impairment	62	88.6
District	710	68.6
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stratford School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	160	2.3	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	88	1.3	1.1
Intellectual Disability	47	0.7	0.5
Learning Disability	407	5.9	5.8
Other Health Impairment	207	3.0	3.3
Other Disabilities	87	1.3	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	82	1.2	1.9
All Disabilities	1,078	15.5	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	62	5.8	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	74	6.9	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$75,868,816	\$10,476	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$11,417,571	\$1,680	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$2,951,791	\$434	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$958,270	\$141	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$7,040,437	\$1,036	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$4,725,421	\$695	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$12,572,100	\$1,850	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$5,076,137	\$1,426	\$1,159
Food services	\$761,823	\$112	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$1,522,860	\$224	\$151
Total	\$122,895,225	\$16,970	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$3,875,659	11.8	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	.	.	11.1
Other Salaries	\$10,748,833	32.6	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$4,682,789	14.2	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$3,028,521	9.2	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$8,391,306	25.4	22.5
Supplies	\$54,981	0.2	0.5
Property Services	\$33,253	0.1	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$2,138,429	6.5	7.2
Equipment	\$21,020	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$200	0.0	0.1
Total	\$32,974,992	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		26.8	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	76.4
State	20.8
Federal	2.7
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stratford School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stratford School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	140	92.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	168	90.5
English Learners	32	90.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	307	89.6
Students with Disabilities	66	63.6
District	524	92.4
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	70.1	140	25.9
Male	66.2	109	19.3
Black or African American	60.2	26	9.7
Hispanic or Latino	63.3	48	13.9
White	74.7	150	35.1
English Learners	48.7	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	65.8	69	15.3
Students with Disabilities	51.7	*	*
District	68.1	249	22.5
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2021 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2021

* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	68.6	88.8
Male	57.7	73.3
Black or African American	60.0	81.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	56.4	76.9
White	69.3	84.4
English Learners	33.3	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	56.8	77.4
Students with Disabilities	28.3	58.3
District	63.0	82.1
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stratford School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	25.0%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	32.8%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	82.8%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	22.5%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		92.1%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		92.4%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		91.2%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		63.0%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		55.4%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.2%	2.8%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stratford School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The major goal of the Stratford Public Schools is to create a learning environment in which all students feel welcome and achieve success. During the 2020-21 school year, the SPS followed CDC and local health department guidance in conjunction with the district re-opening plan, implementing modifications where needed due to COVID developments. The 2020-21 school year focus was on social emotional learning and student and family engagement. The SPS pandemic response utilized grant funding for curriculum revision, support for professional learning in digital teaching, SEL, and culturally responsive teaching strategies. Resources were used to continue the support of students and families in accessing online learning as well as academic supports for students during and after the school day. Revision and implementation of the district SRBI process aimed to increase the number of students in tier one instruction. When student and family engagement became a concern, the district used grant funding to establish an outreach team in for grades K-8 in an effort to reduce chronic absenteeism and connect families with resources. Tutoring before, during, and after school was started in all buildings. Summer programs were planned to include, not only academic and social emotional support, but to re-engage students with teachers, peers and academic programming and community resources. These programs were well-attended.

Typically, most Stratford's special education students are educated in their home schools according to the principles of least restrictive environment following goals and objectives aligned to standards-based curricula. The pandemic created a challenge requiring the close coordination and collaboration of district and community resources. Additional personnel were hired to assist in addressing this challenge. Special education personnel continue to work with core academic areas through co-teaching and collaborative initiatives (SRBI) and continuous improvement of district programs. SPS also provides professional development opportunities for both general and special education staff to be trained together in areas of behavior management and strategies for working with students with specific disabilities.

Stratford Public School District ensures that parents are actively engaged in the educational process utilizing school climate survey results in decision-making, goal-setting, and outreach efforts. The district has expanded offerings to parents, such as literacy workshops, family reading nights, read aloud programs, transition breakfasts, and college and career readiness many of which were held through online meetings. Each year parents and guardians are surveyed about the district's efforts to communicate and the survey results are used in goal-setting the following year.

All schools continue to enjoy the support of active PTA and SEPTA groups. The PTA Council (comprised of PTA presidents from each school) meets regularly with the Superintendent. A Special Education Parent Teacher Association holds monthly meetings for parents to network, advocate, and learn about special education resources for students with disabilities.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Stratford community and public schools continue to become more racially, ethnically, and economically diverse. Most Stratford students attend their neighborhood schools, although in adherence to mandated racial balance figures, some students are transported to other schools within the district. Attendance in neighborhood schools increases family engagement and student participation in after-school activities. Exceptions to this protocol are considered on a limited basis and tightly controlled. Schools partner with local community agencies and institutions in a town-wide effort to affirm and support Stratford's rich cultural, religious, and ethnic diversity. SPS is represented on the Youth and Family Advisory Board, the local council for positive youth development, and the School Readiness Council. The Board of Education adopted an equity policy promoting equity and diversity throughout district operations and confronting racism in schools. BOE and other funding provides students and their families access to online resources for learning and effective district communication. SPS convenes a Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion committee, engages Stratford Citizens Addressing Racial Equity (C.A.R.E.), launched the first annual Day of Hope and Healing, and included all stakeholders in the development of SPS Portrait of a Graduate. Stratford staff and students participate in school-based programs to improve climate and support culturally responsive teaching and learning, through ongoing professional development and programs such as Welcoming Schools, RULER, Restorative Practices, Responsive Classroom, Yale's Model United Nations, and multicultural events. The Dual Language program is in its 5th year and fully enrolled. TEACH CT and CES programs guide focused efforts to recruit, hire, and retain minority teachers, administrators, and staff. The SPS Teacher & Training Pathway includes a secondary education focus; 231 students in grades 7-12 surveyed as part of the "Grow Your Own" program expressed an interest in teaching and were invited to be part of the program.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stratford School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Budget allocations for the Stratford Public Schools are submitted by individual schools and departments and are reviewed by central office staff to ensure equity between schools and among levels and alignment with the Board of Education's District Goals and the District and School Improvement Plans. The central office staff, including the Superintendent and the COO, prepares a final budget with input from staff that is submitted to the Board of Education for review and approval. Allocation of resources, including ESSER funds, is determined by individual school needs, as justified in the zero-based budget submissions. Capital improvement and equipment needs are reviewed through the use of the Plant/Planning Committee and adoption of a five (5) year capital improvement and equipment plan (CIP/CEP). The CIP/CEP is presented to town officials for incorporation into budgetary deliberations through a liaison committee between the Town Council and the Board of Education. Data are reviewed annually to ensure each school has an equitable distribution of fundamental and supportive resources to achieve district goals for safety and student success.